Dulles and other administration officials continued to advocate for this aid by highlighting the China-India economic competition. On Capitol Hill, he highlighted the "striking contrast" between communist China and India's "notable experiment in free government." Major General George C. Stewart, the director of the Defense Department's Office of Military Assistance, stressed that from a military perspective, for US national security the loss of India would be "equally as great a disaster as the loss of China." Appealing to the China bloc members on the House Foreign Affairs Committee, Stassen, who oversaw foreign aid programs, highlighted India's "relative strategic position" vis-à-vis China. He asserted that Washington had already once made the error of basing China policy on adverse perceptions of Jiang; it should not repeat that mistake by basing India policy on views of Nehru. Assistant Secretary of State Henry Alfred Byroade argued that any termination of aid would weaken the hands of those in India who were friendly to the US. And Allen stated that it was crucial to dispel the notion in Asia that the US had only "one string to our bow" (i.e., military means to solve problems). The US needed to help the democratic Indian government "deliver the goods."[280] The administration found support from senators like H. Alexander Smith and Hubert Humphrey. They also managed to convince skeptics like Senator J. William Fulbright, who came to believe that one of the most important questions was "whether or not India, with our assistance, is making greater progress than China with the Russian assistance."[281]

On Delhi's part, as US intelligence had predicted, the need for that American assistance helped prevent a "clear-cut break" with the US after the announcement of military aid to Pakistan.[282] Nehru warned against any knee-jerk Indian rejection of US aid in retaliation or any statement about forsaking such aid.[283] The need for aid also caused Indian officials to express deep concern about the deterioration in US-India relations in March–April 1954.[284] Furthermore, later that year, it partly led to Nehru advising against public ranting against SEATO.[285]

As the internal Eisenhower administration debate about aid broadly and to nonaligned India specifically continued in summer and fall 1954, China remained part of the discussion. The Far East bureau's economic coordinator contradicted his boss, contending that the US could not wait for countries like India to come to their senses; they needed immediate